



Inspection Report

Sea Lion Splash LLC
1027 N. Ranch Road 783
Harper, TX 78631

Customer ID: **500549**
Certificate: **74-C-1185**
Site: 004
Sea Lion Splash LLC

Type: NEW SITE INSPECTION
Date: 04-DEC-2025

2.40(a)(1)

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

The current written program of veterinary care is tailored specifically to California Sea Lions and South American Sea Lions at the licensee's primary site in Texas. The licensee intends to house Harbor Seals at this site in Florida and has not yet updated the PVC to address the veterinary care for these animals at this location. A written program of veterinary care specific to the facility and animal species held within is necessary to facilitate communication between the attending veterinarian, the on-site animal care staff and the facility owner. It ensures animals will receive consistent and timely veterinary diagnoses and treatment of diseases, illnesses, and injuries. Each exhibitor with a part time attending veterinarian under formal arrangements shall include a written program of veterinary care and regularly scheduled visits to the premises of the exhibitor.

3.101(a)(1)

Facilities, general.

Multiple areas within the primary enclosures intended for California Sea Lions (CA SL) and Harbor Seals (HS) were in need of repair or required the removal of potentially unsafe objects.

In the primary enclosure containing pool #1 under the metal barn, USDA staff identified hanging electrical boxes with live uncovered outlets. Additionally, a water hose station with two hoses was located within the enclosure. Both these items were within the reach of CA SL and HS.

In the primary enclosure containing the kidney-shaped pool #2, the metal fencing included metal hooks intended to hold a water hose as well as cleaning implements such as a broom and squeegee. These were within the reach of CA SL.

In the primary enclosure containing the circular pool #3, the concrete pad surrounding the pool was cracked, creating sharp uneven sections. The fiberglass edges of the pool had separated from the concrete, creating sharp points.

Additionally, a metal box for old electrical connections protruded from the floor the enclosure while an old tube with dead electrical wires was easily exposed with a simple push of the tube's top.

In the covered enclosure containing the rectangular medical pool, the edges of the concrete and the pool had separated and created sharp uneven sections. Metal hooks were placed on the wall of the building and within reach of a CA SL. A hose and waterspout were also located within the enclosure. An electrical box with uncovered outlets was also within reach of CA SL.

In the primary enclosure containing the oval pool #5 with the manatee food filter, a section of the hard plastic filter had cracked creating a sharp point.

Prepared By: E RODRIGUEZ

USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Date:
11-DEC-2025

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

Received by Title: Licensee

Date:
11-DEC-2025



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The inclusion of sharp points, electrical equipment and water hoses within the primary enclosures pose safety risks to any animals contained therein. Indoor and outdoor housing facilities for marine mammals must be structurally sound and must be maintained in good repair to protect the animals from injury, to contain the animals within the facility, and to restrict the entrance of unwanted animals.

3.101(b)

Facilities, general.

The written contingency plan provided at the time of the inspection included details specific to the animals and the site at the licensee's primary location in Texas. The plan did not include specific emergency procedures describing the processes at the site in Florida with the equipment available to on-site staff. Additionally, the written contingency plan must be submitted to and approved by the Deputy Administrator regarding the emergency sources of water and electric power in the event of failure of the primary sources. A written contingency plan tailored to the animals and the specific location in Florida is crucial for on-site staff to successfully provide for the health and well-being of the marine mammals housed in the event of failure of the primary sources. Reliable and adequate sources of water and electric power must be provided to marine mammal facilities, and the facility must have a Deputy Administrator approved written contingency plan.

3.101(d)

Facilities, general.

An open shelf located above the washing station in the marine mammal food preparation area contained an assortment of bottles of insecticide and cleaning supplies that may be toxic or harmful to marine mammals. Any leakage or spillage of these substances onto animal used objects or food supplies may be ingested or come into contact with marine mammals. No substances that are known to be or may be toxic or harmful to marine mammals may be stored or maintained in the marine mammal food storage or preparation areas, except that cleaning agents may be kept in secured cabinets designed and located to prevent food contamination.

3.103(c)

Facilities, outdoor.

Multiple areas of the facility's perimeter fence were under 6ft in height. The deficiencies ranged from 1-5 inches under 6ft. Additionally, two sections of the perimeter fence were not flush with the outside walls of buildings included as part of the perimeter. The larger separation was over 8 inches away from the wall of the building. A panel of the perimeter fence was placed adjacent to a large brick post that effectively decreased the fence's height to 3ft. Another section of the perimeter fence had an opening at the bottom approximately 1ft in height. These deficiencies may allow animals or unauthorized persons access to the facility. Additionally, they decrease the efficiency of the perimeter fence's ability to act as a secondary containment system for the marine mammals contained therein. All outdoor housing facilities must be enclosed by a perimeter fence that is of sufficient height to keep animals and unauthorized persons out. The fence must be constructed so that it protects marine mammals by restricting animals and unauthorized persons from going through it or under and having contact with the marine mammals, and so that it can function as a secondary containment system for the animals in the facility when appropriate.

3.107(a)(2)

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Sanitation

The primary enclosure housing pool #1 within the metal building contained insulation debris from a recent pressure washing. The debris had fallen from the ceiling and into the pool water. Pieces ranged in size from the diameter of a blueberry to the diameter of a large strawberry. Potential ingestion of this debris by marine mammals could lead to serious health problems. Particulate animal and food waste, trash, or debris that enters the primary enclosure pools of water must be removed at least daily, or as often as necessary, to maintain the required water quality and to minimize the health and disease hazards to the marine mammals.

This inspection was a site approval inspection.

This site is not ready for approval to conduct activity covered under your current Animal Welfare Act License.

Conducting regulated activities at a non-approved site is a violation of the Animal Welfare Act.

Please contact your inspector to schedule your next new site approval inspection.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with the licensee.

Additional Inspectors:

Kelly Helmick, Senior Veterinary Medical Officer

Prepared By: E RODRIGUEZ

USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
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Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
500549	74-C-1185	004	Sea Lion Splash LLC	04-DEC-2025

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000000	NONE	NONE
000000	Total	